My research, teaching, and mentoring philosophy strives to cultivate both **intellectual rigor** and **compassionate care**. Reflecting my research, my approach is rooted in feminist and decolonial pedagogies [1–5], promoting **empathy, self-reflection, and independence** and equipping students to critically examine the social dimensions of technology. I view my research and teaching as a reciprocal process of learning and transformation, one that empowers students to question how systems of power shape technology and to imagine more equitable futures [6].

Throughout my academic career, I have contested with the idea of privacy and security through technical and human-centered, justice-oriented research, converging on a central question: how do technologies enable abusers to exploit power & control and perpetuate interpersonal and structural violence, and how can private and secure design help communities reclaim safety, healing, and liberation?

I began my technical training with a Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science & Engineering from the Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology, Delhi (2013 to 2017), where my coursework and undergraduate thesis introduced me to systems security research. After graduating, I spent several years in the industry to utilize my security skills to real-world applications. The industry experiences led me to pursue a Research Fellowship at Microsoft Research India (2020–2021), where I worked across the Technology for Empowerment group and the Confidential Computing Group. I designed a privacy-preserving COVID-19 health certificate issuance system built on Microsoft's Confidential Computing Framework, conducted security evaluations of Trusted Execution Environments for GPUs, and developed a tool chain to evaluate one of the first formally verified secure boot implementations on commodity hardware. These industry roles sharpened my interest in technical privacy engineering against canonical adversarial threat models.

At the University of Wisconsin–Madison, I went through my own experiences of violence in my personal and professional life from my ex-advisor through a long journey to find healing and resilience. As a violence survivor and an immigrant, I resolved to reciprocate my knowledge and experiences of support back to the gender-based violence survivors. I embodying cultural and trauma sensitivity to study violence and impacts on communities. Embracing an *advocacy-researcher* practice, I got involved as a consultant at the Madison Tech Clinic (MTC). Now, I direct the operations and outreach at MTC, a trauma-informed intervention that has supported 180+ survivors with their digital safety needs. I have personally supported 40+ survivors and lead the outreach efforts to build partnerships with 26 GBV advocacy organizations, spreading MTC's services across 32 counties in the state of Wisconsin, US. As a first-generation Computer Science PhD student, I had the opportunity to take interdisciplinary courses for my minor spanning Psychology, Gender & Women's Studies, Law, and Education Policy; courses which are rarely accessible in a computer science program in India. My work uses a variety of social theories to inform technical research and interventions. I have also been a part of the Sexual Violence Research Initiative and leading the Decolonial Collective, an interdisciplinary reading group with scholars who are interested in challenging the dominant epistemologies of Western empiricism. Such an interdisciplinary education and research collaboration allowed me to view safety more broadly that crosses disciplinary boundaries.

Amid scientific acceleration, emerging technologies (e.g. AI systems) introduce new privacy crises, enabling surveillance, oppression, and extraction of resources leading to climate destruction. I use sensitive social justice theories to inform the design of AI towards transparency, responsibility, and self-determination. I am committed to designing interventions informed by the realities of the people most affected by its failures by collaborating directly with impacted communities, advocates, and policymakers. My work reciprocity towards participants and research communities (in mentorship, advocacy, and service). I have a strong desire and ability to establish interdisciplinary collaborations and community-engaged partnerships.

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